

Since 2003, Hong Kong residential prices have been on an uptrend. It has registered stronger growth at +10.5% compound annual growth rate (CAGR) in the last decade (2006 to 2016) versus the previous decade (1996 to 2006) of -3.7%. It has beaten the inflation rate of +3.2% CAGR and the Hang Seng Index of +1.0% consistently. Apart from low interest rates (close to zero Fed rate) since 2009, a favorable undersupplied market and robust domestic/investment demand have been the key reasons.

From a demographic perspective, new immigrants, non-local students, graduates and employees have been driving the demand for private residential units. In 2015, more than 56,000 people obtained work-related visas. About 30% of the 45,000 Chinese immigrants in 2016 had “one-way permits” to stay in private units. Meanwhile, 15,000 non-local students (the highest ever) enrolled in university programs in 2015/16. Many of these received permanent residency (PR) status after being in Hong Kong for seven years, including their university stay, and do not have to pay additional stamp duty for purchasing a residential unit.

Abundant liquidity and high local investment demand are other driving forces. Investors accounted for 40% of private residential sales in 2011. This ratio reduced to 30% in 2016 after introduction of double stamp duty and buyers stamp duty, and further reduced to around 10% of sales volume after the government raised the double stamp duty rate again in November 2016. Despite the decline in the number of foreigners buying units, we see local home buyers use the loophole to purchase multiple units using single sale and purchase agreements to avoid heavy stamp duty. Hong Kong remains an aspirational place to own property for mainland Chinese.

Hong Kong has been experiencing a shortage of private housing in the past 10 years or so, especially as the number of persons per household is decreasing. Private residential stock has grown at a CAGR of +0.8% in last decade, quite similar to population growth at +0.7% per annum but much lower than +1.1% domestic household growth. Despite the government increasing land supply in the last four years, completions lagged but now the supply of completed units is expected to reach 17,000 to 18,000 in 2017, much higher than the average of 12,000 in the last five years.



自2003年起，香港樓價一直節節向上。在2006年至2016年期間，香港樓價取得了+10.5%的複合年均增長率，遠高於1996年至2006年的-3.7%，亦一直高於+3.2%的通貨膨脹複合年均增長率，以及+1%的恆生指數增長。除了自2009年起的低利率（接近美國聯邦儲備銀行的零利率）外，供應不足及需求強勁的本地/投資市場乃關鍵因素。

從人口學角度出發，新移民及非本地學生、畢業生及僱員等，均是私人住宅需求的動力。2015年，逾56,000人獲發工作簽證。45,000名中國大陸新移民中，約30%獲發單程證並居於私人住宅。與此同時，15,000名非本地學生——此乃歷來最高數字——於2015/16學年在香港各大專院校就讀；其中不少人在香港居住滿7年後——包括其學生年代——已獲發香港永久居民身份，故無需因購買住宅單位支付額外印花稅。

資金充足及本地投資需求龐大，亦是主要的驅動因素。2011年，私人住宅交易中40%屬投資性質。香港政府實施雙重印花稅及買家印花稅後，比例稍微回落至2016年的30%；香港政府於2016年11月提高雙重印花稅後，比例進一步下跌至10%。儘管外地買家購買私人住宅的數字有所下降，但本地買家為避免印花稅，利用漏洞以單一合同形式購買多個住宅單位。對中國大陸居民而言，香港仍然是購買房地產的理想之地。

過去10年，香港一直面臨私人房屋短缺的問題，每戶人數正在減少是其中一個成因。過去10年，私人住宅庫存錄得+0.8%的複合年均增長率，與每年+0.7%的人口增長率相若，卻遠低於+1.1%的本地家庭增長率。儘管政府在過去4年增加土地供應量，但住宅單位的建成速度卻相對慢；不過，新建成住宅單位數量在2017年將上升至17,000至18,000個，遠高於過去5年的每年平均12,000個。

從人口學角度出發，新移民及非本地學生、畢業生及僱員等，都是私人住宅需求的動力。

”